

Sana Tariq

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Berkeley, California

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Political Science (*International Relations*) 2025 - current
University of California, Berkeley

M.A. in International Relations 2023 - 2025
University of Chicago

Bachelor's in International Politics 2013 - 2017
Georgetown University in Qatar

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Lead Researcher June 2024 – June 2025
Centre on Armed Groups

- Led \$230,000 research study into the situation of Afghan women under the Taliban, funded by Governments of Switzerland and Sweden
- Briefed 15 diplomatic missions to Afghanistan on the findings

Research Fellow (Mediation) Nov. 2020 – Sept. 2023
Center for Conflict and Humanitarian Studies, Qatar

- Conducted academic and policy research into conflict management in Afghanistan and the Middle East, and produced briefings for Qatari MOFA
- Coordinated mediation backchannels for the Afghan peace process in Doha

Research Analyst (Yemen) July 2019 – Nov. 2020
UNESCO, Qatar

- Designed and analysed the data monitoring framework for \$12 million EU-funded peacebuilding and humanitarian project in Yemen, and provided operational analysis on field challenges in Yemen
- Produced concept notes, donor reporting, and CSO capacity assessment

AWARDS AND GRANTS

Simpson Predoctoral Fellowship, GIAS UC Berkeley	2026
University of Chicago CIR research grant	2024
University of Chicago CIR scholarship	2023-2024
Phi Beta Kappa Lepgold Award, Georgetown University	2017
Phi Beta Kappa (top 5% of graduating class)	2017
Graduate Research Grant, Georgetown University in Qatar	2017
International Politics Outstanding Student Award, GU-Qatar	2017
Research Grant, Georgetown University in Qatar	2016
Alpha Sigma Nu (top 2% of graduating class)	2015
Qatar Foundation scholarship	2014-2017
Georgetown University in Qatar scholarship	2013-2017

WORKING PAPERS

- “Defection and Non-Defection in Armed Groups during Peace Processes: The Taliban”
- “The ‘Defection Dilemma’: Coup-Proofing in Armed Groups”
- “Negotiating Inclusion: Persuasion, Pragmatism, and Afghan Women under the Taliban”
- “Post-Cold War Norms and Bargaining Failure in Civil War”

POLICY ANALYSIS

- “The Taliban’s crisis of diplomacy.” *United States Institute of Peace*, December 2022. [Link](#).
- “How not to negotiate with the Taliban.” *Lawfare*. May 2023. [Link](#).
- “Afghan girls need to be back in school. Here’s how to help.” *The New Humanitarian*, November 2022. [Link](#).

TRAININGS

UN OHCHR Human Rights Training	May 2020
UN Results-Based Management Training	September 2019

SKILLS

Languages: native English, fluent Urdu, advanced Arabic (modern standard)
Software: R